# Consumer Awareness



# Introduction

Philosophy often delves into the essence and the nature of existence, but these have been extensively explored, arguably to the point of diminishing returns. What more could be argued of what the point of the self or time itself is supposed to be. This traditional focus, epitomized by the intense scrutiny and eventual turmoil of Nietzsche, the last of the great philosophers, suggests a limitation in the field's further development. My pamphlet, however, aims to shift this perspective towards a more practical application of philosophy, contemplating how we, as humans, should think and identify the broader threats that lie ahead. It emphasizes the necessity of reevaluating our priorities in the face of the human-industrial complex, which drives us to address geopolitical needs as urgent due to our relentless extraction of Earth's resources and subsequent competition for them. Rather, the approach presented here is that to successfully navigate through the great filter, our species must adopt radically different goals, underscoring the relevance of philosophy in tackling these contemporary challenges.

The essence of my argument is rooted in the inherent power of individual consumers within society. Our world is broadly categorized into three groups: the elite, who pursue extravagant lifestyles; the vast majority of consumers in Western societies; and the global poor, marginalized by their lack of resources, education, or motivation. In contrast to the industrial era, when economic growth seemed limitless due to the exploitation of the Earth's resources, we now face a future where the metaphorical pie is shrinking. This shift necessitates a profound transformation

in our societal structure, achievable only through leveraging the influence of consumers. Unlike the disenfranchised poor or the elite, embroiled in their quests for greater power and wealth, it is the consumer who truly wields the power. I propose the formation of a new political entity: the consumer body. This body, empowered by its purchasing decisions, holds the potential to dictate significant societal changes. The key to navigating our challenges lies in recognizing and mobilizing the consumer's latent power.

Acknowledging the immense complexity of our modern societies is fundamental; the breadth and intricacy of systems in place are such that no single individual can grasp them entirely. My understanding and portrayal will inevitably be incomplete, overlooking vast areas of knowledge and nuance. Consequently, this work is not intended to be a comprehensive philosophy on how to live our lives. Instead, it aims to highlight a singular, yet pivotal concept: the formidable power of the consumer body. The evolution of this idea spans over a decade, reflecting my observations on societal trends and the potential for significant change. This treatise is crafted with the intention of rallying support for the empowerment of the consumer body, emphasizing the substantial political and economic influence individuals can wield collectively. It is my hope that this discourse, while not exhaustive, will serve as a straightforward and accessible overview, setting the stage for a deeper exploration of the issues at hand. My objective is not to present a complex or challenging read, but rather to offer a concise introduction before delving into more detailed discussions.

# Section One

The idea that every unit of currency represents a vote encapsulates a critical insight into consumer influence within our economic system. When we spend money, we are essentially casting votes in favor of the products and services we purchase. This idea highlights a fundamental oversight in how capitalism is often conceptualized and practiced. Traditional capitalism is largely driven by supply-side dynamics, where the system rewards successful enterprises and penalizes those that fail. However, this model depends heavily on the availability of credit to fuel the creation of alternatives that meet consumer demand. If, during periods of abundant credit, the market fails to generate desirable alternatives, then such options may never materialize.

Consider the issue of advocating for higher wages for workers. Economically, for wages to increase, the cost of goods and services would generally need to rise to cover these higher labor costs. However, since there is no straightforward mechanism for consumers to explicitly indicate their willingness to pay more for products for better wages for workers, this need goes unmet. Our current economic structures do not provide a clear way for such consumer preferences to be communicated or acted upon, leading to a disconnect between consumer intentions and market outcomes. This gap in the system reveals the limitations of relying solely on market forces to address social and economic issues, underscoring the need for more nuanced mechanisms that can better translate consumer values into market dynamics.

So what if any tools exist for the consumer to voice their displeasure? There is of course one concept, the boycott. The boycott stands as the primary, albeit limited, tool through which consumers can exert their influence over businesses in response to their practices or policies. Effective across various political spectrums, boycotts act as a form of protest—a "stick" rather than a "carrot"—whereby consumers withhold their spending to enforce change. However, this approach often lacks the nuance to support positive practices or to directly promote desired outcomes in a constructive manner.

The boycott is a clumsy tool, unwieldy, not necessarily effective for either the reason of not forcing a change or note expressing the poignant reasons why something should change. But are there any so-called “carrots” for the consumer, ways that they can reward a behavior? Crowdfunding platforms exist, but these are typically geared towards charitable causes rather than serving as a direct mechanism for consumers. In our previous example of consumer willingness to pay more for ethically produced goods or fair labor practices, there is absolutely no way to incentivize positive corporate or business behavior. While crowdfunding platforms mobilize financial resources for specific projects, they do not seamlessly integrate into everyday consumer decision-making processes.

Furthermore, the rise of subscription models represents another dimension of consumer choice, offering ongoing revenue streams for businesses and when cut off can express dissatisfaction. However, the ease with which subscriptions can be canceled means they do not necessarily guarantee long-term financial

stability for businesses, nor do they empower consumers to influence corporate policies in meaningful ways. Consumers can discontinue a subscription for any number of reasons rather than for reasons of morality or ethical decision making.

Political lobbying, particularly by affluent individuals and corporate interests, does play a significant role in shaping market and regulatory environments. But I would argue it is so secondary to consumer spending, that if one could shift consumer spending for various political or cultural forces, that power would instantly sway into the hands' of the masses. For now, lobbying is the only form of influence that actually works but it is predominantly accessible to only the elite and does not adequately represent the broader consumer base or harness the collective power of consumers. I would argue and only with this statement, that this leads to inequality divisions within a nation-state.

These observations point to a significant gap in the economic system: there is no comprehensive mechanism that allows consumers to actively participate in shaping the market according to their ethical, social, and economic values. To truly empower consumers, new models need to be developed that allow spending to directly reflect consumer preferences and values, potentially transforming the market to better align with the broader interests of society. This could involve innovations in how products are priced and sold, perhaps incorporating more transparent, participatory methods of setting prices or deciding company policies, thereby making the consumer truly a part of the economic conversation rather than just the endpoint of it.

The ESG (Environmental, Social, and Governance) model exemplifies a top-down approach where executives attempt to make ethical or socially responsible decisions without a democratic input from consumers. This method often fails to reflect the diverse values and priorities of the consumer base, underscoring the need for a more participatory model of economic decision-making. To put it simply, educated and well-informed board members make vague guesses as to what large masses of people want and then make very broad decisions to force corporations to comply with loans, resulting in marginalization of groups or pandering to others. Further, some of these goals may not be realistic or aren't measured properly or are seeming arbitrary.

Genuine decision-making should be driven by direct input from people expressing their desires, promoting a democratization of capitalism rather than a restrictive or authoritarian approach. Imagine a tool that made this possible. What concerns might consumers prioritize? What could be the theoretical impact of such a tool? We're exploring possibilities here—not the current state of the world or entrenched political ideologies, but what could potentially be achieved. There may be unexplored ideas or unforeseen shifts in direction. The key is to grasp the immense potential and power that lies in the hands of you, the consumer. Now, let's become aware.

## Cultural Choices

In the film industry, the current model restricts consumer choices to pre-existing productions. Imagine if studios showcased an array of film scripts to the public, providing summaries and allowing viewers to vote on the projects they'd like to see brought to life. This approach would not only make cultural production more democratic but could also encourage a greater variety of creative and ambitious projects. With a secure income from consumer votes, studios might be more inclined to embrace creative risks.

Taking this idea further, consider if local businesses or corporations funded a cultural hub or museum. Imagine a plaza designed without phone signal, filled with bars and cafes that foster face-to-face conversations. This space could act as a modern town square where people give speeches, share ideas, or enjoy mini concerts. Such a center for self-expression and social interaction could help forge strong community identities and meet the deep human need for connection in today’s world.

In the arts, businesses could serve as patrons, supporting not only painters but also sculptors, musicians, and poets. By backing these artists, new thoughts and ideas could flourish, all sparked by consumer demand for a revolution in creativity. Imagine if every purchase at Wal-Mart or your local grocery store contributed to a fund that supports struggling artists, allowing them to enrich our culture. This kind of funding, sustained over time, could transform the arts landscape. The current world often feels drab and expressionless because genuine creativity and emotion aren’t sufficiently rewarded or recognized.

## Political Choices

On the political front, the current system of corporate lobbying represents the interests of companies rather than consumers. If retailers, for example, transparently aligned a portion of their profits to support specific political candidates or policies, consumers could directly influence politics through their purchasing choices. This system would allow consumers to "vote" with their dollars, supporting businesses that advocate for policies they agree with. If candidates knew they could receive financial backing through such a system, it could lead to a broader range of political options and necessary legal reforms, both domestically and globally.

Both of these examples highlight the potential for a more democratized economic system where consumers directly influence both cultural production and political processes. This would not only empower consumers but also lead to a more diverse and responsive market, aligning more closely with the public's interests and values. This approach challenges the traditional, centralized systems of decision-making and opens up new possibilities for consumer engagement and influence in the economy.

Much like how derivatives and credit promises drive our financial system, the guaranteed promise of consumer spending could redefine financial dynamics and lead to more accurate pricing. This concept could extend into "political credit," where politicians'

promises to advocate for certain policies could be quantified and auctioned to companies. The proceeds from such auctions could then be taxed and redistributed to benefit local communities.

To illustrate, consider a scenario where drilling rights within a community are auctioned off. These rights could be "sold" through political backers to various politicians, with the transaction benefiting both political campaigns and the community itself. The revenue generated could be split between political contributions and local initiatives, ensuring that communities profit directly from their resources. This system would also help ensure that policy advocacy does not alienate local populations but instead supports them in tangible ways, such as funding for education, the arts, healthcare, and humanitarian efforts. This approach could potentially replace lengthy and contentious court battles with a more direct and beneficial system of resource management and community support.

Where local resources align with incentives, significant opportunities emerge. Consider local assets—ranging from metals to fossil fuels—which might not currently be profitable or politically viable to exploit. If the potential for exploiting these resources were openly traded on financial markets by the local populace, in exchange for potential revenue gains, it could be a game-changer. This system, supported by both local consumer spending and external investment, could bring a wealth of resources from politically sensitive areas to the market.

Such a mechanism has the potential to significantly increase resource availability and alleviate inflationary pressures, even in a world that is becoming increasingly polarized. By enabling communities to have direct control and benefit from their resources, it not only empowers them but also stabilizes resource-driven economic dynamics on a larger scale. One may ask what difference is that from the current world system? The difference being that consumers in the area willingly agree to the resource extraction in exchange for demands and willingly spend or help that foreign business extract resources in exchange for well written public demands. This right for consumer help and willingness is what is sold, as well as the potential resources.

## Energy Choices

The domain of energy production and consumption is pivotal for addressing environmental concerns, particularly the reliance on fossil fuels. Many consumers are eager for a shift towards sustainable energy sources, yet face the limitation of current green technologies which, at times, can paradoxically result in a net increase in carbon emissions due to the entire lifecycle of the technology—from mining to recycling. For example, electric cars are in general significantly more green because they are powered by the local grid, which even if it’s powered by coal is still better than the pollution from a combustible engine where only a fraction of the fossil fuel is converted into power. However, the issue with electric vehicles is the requirements of lithium which is a very rare resource and require significant extraction as well as the recycling of these lithium batteries remains a large question mark.

To better align consumer preferences with energy production, a competitive, consumer-driven funding model could be implemented. This model would involve consumers contributing to a prize pool that incentivizes companies and startups working on innovative energy solutions, especially in promising yet underfunded areas like nuclear fusion. This approach could dramatically boost research and development, offering an alternative to traditional funding sources such as venture capital and government subsidies. Funding could also support smaller-scale fission reactors, recognizing that significant energy innovations might not emerge rapidly enough through conventional investment routes. By mobilizing significant consumer spending, not just driven by immediate profit motives, this model could accelerate the arrival of major energy breakthroughs that seem perpetually on the horizon.

For instance, every purchase could include a micro-contribution to fund sustainable energy innovations. Consumers could also direct their spending towards businesses that invest in sustainable practices, such as a grocery store installing solar panels. In return, these businesses could offer incentives back to consumers, such as discounts or loyalty benefits, effectively creating a feedback loop where businesses are rewarded for investing in sustainability, and consumers benefit from lower costs due to energy savings.

Moreover, by establishing a transparent, direct connection between consumer spending and energy choices, consumers can meaningfully act on their environmental concerns. This shift could transform the funding and prioritization of energy projects,

creating a market where sustainable and innovative energy solutions receive the most financial support. For instance, if a product uses non-biodegradable plastic, consumers could choose to avoid it based solely on its packaging, thereby reducing market demand for it, even if it's slightly cheaper. This model not only decentralizes decision-making but also empowers consumers to drive economic trends through their purchasing decisions, effectively pushing companies towards more sustainable practices.

## Scientific Choices

The scientific community often grapples with the challenge of securing sustainable funding for long-term research projects. Traditional grant systems, while essential, can become competitive arenas where the focus shifts towards marketing one's research to secure funding instead of progress on that front. This can divert attention and resources away from actual scientific inquiry and innovation.

A transformative approach could involve consumer-driven funding streams, where individuals pledge to support businesses that are committed to investing in specific areas of research. This could establish a continuous flow of funding directly tied to consumer interest and engagement, providing a stable financial base for long-term scientific breakthroughs. By implementing a progress meter or a similar transparency tool, consumers could see real-time updates on how their contributions are driving scientific advancements, fostering a stronger connection between consumer spending and scientific development.

## Broader Implications

The point is that there are various categories that consumers can push to get their spending unified behind, some categories can be more vouched for than others. In essence, the disconnect between consumer power and its expression in economic terms raises significant questions. Despite having greater rights and a voice in many other areas of society, consumers often lack the mechanisms to influence economic outcomes in a meaningful and directed way. The current global economy does not adequately capture or leverage consumer sentiments that could drive substantial change. This oversight highlights the need for a more democratized financial system where consumer choices extend beyond superficial preferences for products and services to substantive decisions about societal and global priorities.

By reimagining economic models to incorporate direct consumer input into funding and product development decisions, we can harness what might be humanity's strongest force for change: the collective economic power of the consumer body. This shift would not only make economic systems more reflective of and responsive to public values and needs but also empower consumers to act as active participants in shaping the future direction of society and innovation.

# Section Two

## Failure to Act

What incentives would drive a consumer to commit to spending more, or allocate a specific portion of their budget to a particular business? And what if they fail to honor their pledge? Ultimately,

changing self-serving behavior for the greater good hinges on two key factors: the fear of missing out and the consequences of misbehavior. For instance, if a business received significant consumer support but failed to fulfill promises like installing solar panels or passing on cost savings, they could quickly lose trust. Legal action is costly and often ineffective. A more immediate consequence would be public shaming and having the business blacklisted from the platform.

This leads to the concept of a pseudonymous profile. While any user could create one, its initial impact would be minimal. Over time, as users validate their spending through the platform, the credibility and influence of their profile would grow, akin to a credit score, but focusing on consumer behavior. The more reputable the profile, the more its pledges influence business decisions.

But what incentives exist beyond the desire to do good? The answer lies in tangible rewards. For instance, businesses might pool resources for charitable efforts. A consumer with a high score could receive aid for medical bills or gain access to volunteers for personal needs like elderly care. These incentives demonstrate how strategic spending and pledges can offer direct benefits, encouraging consumers to prioritize their spending decisions effectively.

## Discounts

The most direct benefit for consumers could be discounts or cashback when making purchases within their pledged system. Such benefits could realistically stem from reductions in product or service input costs, particularly fixed energy costs like lighting

and stocking shelves. Implementing this would require significant infrastructure changes—embracing the idea that if something has been the same for 30 years, it's time for an upgrade. For instance, adopting solar panels or small wind turbines could reduce energy costs. Similarly, deploying electric semi-trucks tailored for a specific grocery store chain could become feasible if consumers collectively back such initiatives. While the price reductions from these changes might be minimal initially, they represent a practical first step towards engaging consumer participation.

This leads to the broader principle that the larger the scale, the more effective the impact. It's crucial for consumers to unify their shopping habits—whether for shoes, groceries, or oil changes—at designated businesses. This unified approach would not only amplify the collective consumer influence but also encourage a wider range of businesses to contribute to a larger consumer pool, ultimately benefiting those who support and nurture this ecosystem.

## Product Variety

One of the most immediate and tangible benefits of this system is the ability for consumers to vote on which businesses should establish themselves in their local communities. If there's enough demand and pledged spending meets or exceeds the associated costs, it logically follows that such a business should be built. This process could even become a globally auctioned service. However, this raises a deeper question: Why are our grocery stores often stocked with junk food? Is it truly consumer choice, or does it boil down to ease of sale and profit margins?

If given the choice, it’s likely that consumers would opt for healthier, more environmentally friendly products and sustainable packaging. To implement such changes, more substantial pledges would be necessary. Small, incremental changes could initially be tested in smaller communities with a keen interest in consumer awareness. The principle is clear: if consumers consistently show a preference for certain products and back this up with their spending pledges, ignoring these preferences would be a failure on the part of businesses. This could herald a shift from fast food to fast, healthy food, driven by consumer choice and spending power.

## Manpower

A second stage of rewards in a consumer-driven system could involve volunteer manpower, drawing a fine line to avoid the pitfalls of overly authoritarian models like China's social credit system. Instead, this system would emphasize voluntary participation rather than mandating it. For instance, to boost their spending score, individuals could volunteer their time and skills. A local construction company might install solar panels for free at a business in exchange for a significant boost to its profile, creating a sustainable, self-managing system within the community.

This approach has broad implications. For example, a doctor might perform an operation for free on a patient with a high consumer score to increase their own score. Similarly, skills-based volunteering could involve professionals offering their services to those who have achieved a certain level of consumer score. Imagine a scenario where a space is provided for night

classes, taught by volunteer professors to students who also volunteer their time.

This volunteering pledge—"that will be done"—is a powerful concept that is largely absent in our current system, which is bogged down by appointments and queues. Incentivizing participation with perks such as skipping lines or receiving free services could transform how services are accessed and appreciated. Moreover, our educational model, typically reliant on student loans and profitable international students, could shift towards rewarding local, community-focused contributions, reshaping the value we place on education and community service.

## The World’s Accounting Book

Personally, I have completely failed to advance any such business or ideas in this pamphlet, so I have resorted to writing about it to garner attention to the larger consciousness of the consumer. This is due to myself having been unable to secure financing for my ideas. Often nepotistic and unduly vaunted, the entire Venture Capital arm of the United States is not only useless but plausibly dangerous, pushing various social-engineering platforms rather than meaningful progress for humanity. Despite these setbacks, what I’m proposing here is a system where a comprehensive accounting mechanism would be at a city level or even an entire national level that could predict consumer needs to align supply more accurately, thereby reducing waste. For instance, if a store's typical demand for bananas is ten but a thousand are delivered, it results in inefficiency and waste.

Of course such inefficiencies within business logistics is unseen but that doesn't mean inefficiencies, even vast ones aren't there. Take for example the recent price hikes which may be attributed to corporate gouging—a topic beyond this discussion— shows the failure of the free market to prevent price gouging. The exacerbation of inflation by expansive fiat money policies further complicates matters. The more you print, the more inflation you'll feel. However, even on inflationary levels due to waste, measuring and openly displaying consumer demand can be a powerful tool. If we know ten pseudonymous people will buy ten bananas from a store, then we need only send 10 bananas to that grocery store. If consumer demand can be prearranged, then business supply can match it exactly or slightly over exceed it.

So, when it comes to the open display of data amongst all parties the best tool that exists is a blockchain. Display of data across the board of demand going through, likely through an app with payment methods attached to said app could incentivize consumers. A cashback mechanism can take place as well, to financially incentivize consumers. But the leap in behavior must not be a financial incentive but a deep seat political and socioeconomic one.

People need to realize that their true power lies in their spending, not just in their online opinions. It's crucial that discussions about consumer spending habits take place online to understand why people choose to support certain businesses or products. Moreover, coupling this behavior with the effective tool of boycotts can greatly influence market dynamics. There is no stronger force

in the free market than choosing to spend money with a competitor to penalize a business.

If businesses can transparently see why consumers choose their competitors, they will likely adapt their practices to align more closely with popular consumer preferences. This dynamic could be enhanced by a platform where corporations pay for insights into consumer behavior. The funds collected could then be redistributed to consumers who actively share their opinions, incentivizing them to engage more fully. However, beyond financial incentives, it's crucial for consumers to recognize the significant power they wield through their spending choices.

This accounting system must be self-reinforcing and strengthened through active participation. The tragedy of the commons shows that without personal incentives, individuals may not engage fully, potentially undermining collective efforts. Thus, alongside mechanisms like boycotts, this system should penalize non-participation. Consequences might include bans, expulsions, or reduced rewards. For example, if a consumer fails to fulfill a pledge to spend a certain amount at a store in exchange for specific business actions, they would receive fewer benefits within the system.

The core idea is that if consumer behavior is both predictable and incentivized, we can democratize capitalism and create accurate supply systems, thereby generating new wealth. For instance, power plant demand could be more efficiently managed if consumers pledge their expected electricity usage. The goal isn’t necessarily to penalize or reward variations in energy

consumption—since pricing already influences that—but to encourage consumers to maintain consistent usage patterns. For example, a consumer who commits to keeping their thermostat at 72 degrees Fahrenheit for 8 hours daily and verifies this through a linked app could receive a small reward. Such accurate energy accounting could reduce resource extraction by allowing energy suppliers to plan more effectively around confirmed demand. This example illustrates the potential benefits of a sophisticated, though currently hypothetical, accounting system.

The development of a consumer-driven system could lead to the creation of a secondary currency that operates alongside a nation's official currency. While the idea of wealthy individuals "buying" their way into a higher consumer score might seem problematic, it could become a reality. If such transactions could funnel a portion of the proceeds towards the greater good, it might be justifiable. This secondary currency would likely need to be a form of cryptocurrency, to facilitate payments and manage accounts efficiently.

Alternatively, a more socialized system could be considered. Local communities might decide whether purchasing a higher consumer score should be allowed. Personally, I find the notion of buying status rather objectionable, but obstructing the free market often leads to unintended consequences. Therefore, balancing these dynamics within the system's design is crucial to ensure it supports equitable and constructive outcomes.

## The Labor System

Another promising component within the Consumer Awareness system is labor integration. For entry-level or physically demanding jobs, employees could form coalitions to pledge their labor for a specified period at a certain quality level in exchange for tangible benefits.

**Example from Personal Experience:** I once worked in a factory where the break room was subpar and the work physically strenuous, leading to high turnover. If there had been a system in place where my employment history and commitment to the job were tracked via an app, and I could pledge to stay longer to reduce turnover, I would expect certain benefits in return. These could include improvements to the break room, access to massage chairs to ease physical strain, and a higher wage.

**Expanding the Concept:** This labor system could extend to other sectors, such as education and professional training. For instance, a prospective college student and a business could match needs and expectations through this system. The student could take specified courses relevant to the business, which in return, could fund the student's education. This approach could fundamentally transform the job market, encouraging longer tenures in specific fields or companies.

**Beyond Traditional Models:** While unions traditionally negotiate for better wages and benefits, this system could focus more broadly on prospective employment and retention strategies. It could streamline the transition between education and employment, potentially favoring apprenticeships or targeted training over traditional degrees. This would reduce educational

overhead and increase workforce flexibility, making it easier for workers to adapt to changing job markets and for businesses to retain trained, reliable employees.

**Accounting of Energy**

One of the most practical applications of the proposed system could be in managing individual energy consumption. By having users verify their typical energy and product usage, significant efficiencies can be gained, especially when they relocate to another city. This data allows for fine-tuned adjustments in energy supply, helping to optimize city-wide energy planning.

Understanding a consumer's expected thermostat settings or electricity usage can be incredibly valuable, despite the unpredictability of weather changes. Moreover, if consumers indicate the duration of their stay in a city, this information could be used to project population density and corresponding energy needs more accurately.

Power companies, which typically plan for the long term due to the substantial investments involved in energy infrastructure, would greatly benefit from insights into anticipated changes in energy demand. This knowledge allows them to prepare and adjust their capacity planning and development strategies more effectively, ensuring that energy supply aligns closely with future demand.

# Section Three

**Privacy**

The proposed platform, with its detailed tracking of individual behavior, raises significant privacy concerns that could surpass those associated with platforms like Facebook. To safeguard privacy:

1. **Anonymity by Default:** Personal identifiers such as names and addresses should not be entered into the platform. Geolocation should be activated only following a purchase to maintain privacy while still allowing for location-based services.

2. **Financial Security:** Credit card details and other financial data should not be accessible through the app, ensuring that financial information remains secure.

3. **Decision-making Transparency:** Given the potential for mass manipulation, it is crucial that any voting on community improvements or changes is conducted transparently. Organizations that campaign for certain changes or benefits on the platform must operate with high transparency.

4. **Organization Ratings:** All participating organizations should be subject to an individual rating system within the app. This system would allow users to see the reputations and past actions of these entities, aiding them in making informed decisions.

These measures are essential to maintain user trust and ensure that the platform is used responsibly and ethically.
The most secure platform is one that doesn't store user data directly but uses pseudonymous profiles created with public keys, similar to Bitcoin. However, several issues need addressing, such

as resolving disputes between businesses and consumers. This could be managed by third-party arbitrators, preferably users with high consumer scores, to maintain a balanced system. Initially, only a small portion of users may adopt the platform, but as benefits and special access become apparent, it will likely gain popularity and become a status symbol, attracting more users.

Local adaptation is crucial; it's up to the consumers in each city to decide what issues to prioritize, which will vary significantly from one location to another. Proposals for change should ideally come from those with higher consumer scores, giving more weight to users who are actively engaged with the platform. While general voting allows for broad participation in decision-making, there should be no penalties for expressing one’s opinion, thus upholding the principle of enforced anonymity under all circumstances.

For those less adept with technology, partnering with banks to issue a card that integrates their user profile and payment options might be considered, though this raises potential privacy concerns.

**Conclusion**

The ideas proposed here are ambitious and, admittedly, some may be impractical. The key takeaways are twofold: first, every dollar spent is effectively a vote toward something; and second, the real power rests with the consumer. Instead of being passively influenced by corporate and lobbying interests, it is crucial for individuals to assert their strength and influence. There is a

pressing need to democratize capitalism by integrating demand-side accounting, which currently lacks the precision of supply-side metrics. Implementing such systems could significantly reduce energy consumption and increase economic efficiency, potentially helping to overcome the global issue of stagflation. While the ultimate outcome of these ideas might simply be to raise awareness, that in itself could be a substantial achievement.